Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held Electronically
At 1:00 p.m. on October 12, 2021

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
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Present:	Chair - Councillor	A. Khan
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		L. Bower
	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order

Chair Khan called the meeting to order at 1:00 p.m.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 Regular Meeting

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on September 13, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.2 Closed Session

Moved by: L. Bower

That the Minutes of the Closed Session of the General Government Committee held on September 13, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.1, 4.2, 4.5, 4.6 and 4.7 for discussion.

Moved by: S. Collier

That items 4.3 and 4.4 of the consent agenda be adopted.

CARRIED

4.1 CAO-2021-11: Council Ward Constituent Newsletter Update

Committee Members asked questions regarding delivery process and coordination, missed deliveries, opportunities to have the newsletter delivered to senior facilities, and if erroneous deliveries were rectified. Devon Jarvis, Social Media & Communications Coordinator, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford

1. That the remaining Ward Constituent Newsletter January 2022 edition continue to be delivered via GTA Flyer Delivery, as selected by Council at the June 14, 2021 GGC meeting.

CARRIED

4.2 FIN-2021-11: Land Banking Levy

Committee Members discussed an amendment proposed by Regional Councillor Lee and sought clarification regarding the intent and scope of the amendment. Regional Councillor Lee responded to questions from Committee Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Report on the Land Banking Levy be received for information.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Lee

That the motion be amended by adding the following clause:

1. That staff be directed to prepare and send a letter to the Ministry of Municipal Affairs and Housing advocating for Ontario municipalities to be given authority to implement a land banking levy.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the Report on the Land Banking Levy be received for information; and

2. That staff be directed to prepare and send a letter to the Ministry of Municipal Affairs and Housing advocating for Ontario municipalities to be given authority to implement a land banking levy.

CARRIED

4.3 **FIN-2021-14: Tax Section Status Report**

Moved by: S. Collier

That the Tax Section Status Report be received for information.

CARRIED

4.4 **LIS-2021-14: 2022 User Fees and Charges**

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the recommended fees schedule (ATT-1) be approved, effective January 1, 2022; and

2. That the appropriate General Fees By-law be presented to Council for approval.

CARRIED

4.5 **OES-2021-10: Contract Award – Westney Road Streetlighting – Rossland Road to Taunton Road**

Committee Members asked questions regarding funds allocated to contract administration and potential improvements to capital budget project numbering and cross-referencing on detail sheets. Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, and Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council award the contract for Westney Road Streetlights, to The Regional Municipality of Durham in the amount of $637,499.43 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Council approve additional funding of $151,110.74 to be allocated to Capital Account No. 1012911.5870:

Development Reserve	$7,555.54
DC-18-Transportation	$143,555.20
Total	$151,110.74

CARRIED

4.6 **OES-2021-12: 2021 Corporate Security Projects**

Committee Members asked questions regarding the number of security cameras to be installed at the Ajax Community Centre south parking lot, including coverage at the artificial turf fields, wireless technology, reasons for implementing security cameras at the Westney Road leash-free area, opportunities to add additional security cameras and lighting in the future, project funding opportunities, grant programs, security camera sign requirements, and additional funding opportunities for municipalities through the Ontario Cannabis Legalization Fund. Ray Ford, Manager Building Maintenance, D. Meredith, Kassandra Cruciano, Grants, Partnerships and Strategic Initiatives Coordinator, and D. Valentim responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That Council approve the installation of the following corporate security projects in 2021:

    - Panic duress stations at Town Hall and Rotary Park
    - Security cameras and lighting at the Westney Road leash-free area
    - Security cameras at the Ajax Community Centre south parking lot
    - Upgraded security cameras at the Upper Hermitage Park Parking Lot

2. That $133,822.00 be allocated to Capital Account No. 1027111 – Security Projects, based on money received from the Ontario Cannabis Legalization Fund to complete the recommended above projects.

CARRIED

4.7 **PDS-2021-38: Sylvan Drive – Partial Sale of Unopened Road Allowance**

Members had no questions or comments regarding this matter.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council direct staff to dispose of a portion of the Sylvan Drive unopened road allowance to the adjacent land owners (R. & J. Kelly) for compensation in the amount of $3,000 (before HST), plus legal fee recoveries to a maximum of $1,000; and

2. That, following the preparation of a 40R Plan, which outlines the lands to be sold, the following by-laws be considered at a future Council meeting:

    a. a by-law to authorize the stop-up and close the affected portion of Sylvan Drive; and
    b. a by-law to authorize the execution of the Agreement of Purchase and Sale with R. & J. Kelly.

CARRIED

5. Discussion

5.1 PDS-2021-39: Durham Regional Cycling Master Plan 2021

Committee Members asked questions regarding the Regional Active Transportation Coordinator position, signage and wayfinding strategies, and signage design guidelines. John Grieve, Supervisor of Transportation, and Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That the Town of Ajax advise the Region of Durham that it supports in principle the recommended Regional Cycling Master Plan 2021 (RCP), including the proposed active transportation network and supporting policies, but has outstanding concerns as outlined below.

2. That the Town of Ajax request that, prior to presenting the recommended RCP to the Region's Committee of the Whole for endorsement, Durham Region staff have further consultation with all local municipalities to:

   a) further clarify how the various policy initiatives contained within the RCP will be coordinated with existing local municipal policies; and

   b) further clarify the financial implications of the RCP, including the funding approaches to be used, the financial support to be provided to local municipalities, and how that support will be distributed.

3. That the Town of Ajax recommend Durham Region move forward immediately with hiring a Regional Active Transportation Coordinator so that this required staff resource is in place as soon as the RCP receives Regional endorsement; and

4. That a copy of this report be circulated to the Region of Durham and all local Municipalities in Durham Region.

CARRIED

6. Presentations

6.1 PDS-2021-40: Update Lower Harwood Avenue Feasibility Study

J. Grieve delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and discussed background information, east vs. west boulevard screening, functional design, evaluation criteria, and next steps.

Committee Members asked questions regarding safety and cost considerations, design options and impacts, construction costs, opportunities to install parking bumpers or bollards, multi-use path restrictions, opportunities to achieve separation between active transportation and pedestrians, potential requirements to pay back gas tax, and opportunities to improve the Harwood Avenue/Clover Ridge Drive intersection. J. Grieve responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That staff be directed to proceed with the detailed design of an off-road multi-use path on the east side of Harwood Avenue between Bayly Street and Lake Driveway instead of the proposed on-road active transportation facilities as recommended in the 2012 Lower Harwood Study and 2019 Integrated Transportation Master Plan, and report back to Council or the appropriate Standing Committee with information regarding the detailed design, anticipated costs, and funding sources.

2. That staff be directed to include, as part of the detailed design, the removal of existing on-road active transportation facilities on Harwood Avenue between Westney Road and McRae Road, and this section of Harwood Avenue be restored to two vehicle travel lanes in each direction.

CARRIED

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Tyler Morin, Councillor Khan

Opposed: Regional Councillor Dies

6.2 **PDS-2021-41: Hunt Street Extension Feasibility Study Update**

J. Grieve delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein. J. Grieve discussed the background, route alignments, assessment of options, functional design of the preferred alignment, cost comparison, and next steps.

Committee Members asked questions regarding projected rail traffic at the proposed level crossing. J. Grieve responded to questions from Committee Members. Committee Members determined that discussion of potential property acquisitions related to the project should be held in a closed session of the Committee.

Closed Meeting (3:12 p.m.)

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Committee convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Section 239 (2)(c) of the Municipal Act, 2001, as amended, to discuss a matter pertaining to a proposed or pending acquisition or disposition of land by the municipality or local board.

CARRIED

Open Meeting (3:51 p.m.)

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

1. That the preferred alignment ‘Option 1 At-Grade’, identified by the Feasibility Study be endorsed by Council;

2. That Staff be directed to complete the necessary Environmental Assessment addendum and that this project be included in the 2022 Capital Budget submission;

3. That Staff ensure all affected landowners are appropriately engaged as part of the addendum process and that the addendum be completed in 2022; and

4. That following the completion of the Environmental Assessment addendum and prior to the 2023 Capital Budget Submission, staff be directed to bring an update on the Hunt Street extension project to the appropriate standing committee of Council.

CARRIED

8. Adjournment (3:52 p.m.)

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the October 12, 2021 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED